GRADUATE STUDENT INTERNAL ACKNOWLEDGEMENT

Date: _____

Participation in the **Velocity Blockchain Innovation Challenge Powered by Stellar** from November 2nd – November 18th 2026, may lead to your creation of intellectual property (IP) along with your team members. As such, you and your team members will be free to pursue the commercialization of any IP that is created over the course of the Velocity Innovation Challenge after the event has concluded.

As a graduate student at the University of Waterloo you may be engaged in sponsored research activities where external third parties may have certain rights to IP arising from your thesis work. In such cases you should be aware that your participation in the Velocity Innovation Challenge could interfere with prior commitments made to your research activities should you include your thesis work in your team submission for the Velocity Innovation Challenge.

As a graduate student at the University of Waterloo, if you are not engaged in sponsored research activities, your graduate research and the IP generated therein is owned by you, the inventor. Should you use some or all of your graduate research as part of your submission for the Velocity Innovation Challenge, this could constitute a public disclosure which may impede your ability to patent your IP at a later date. It may also grant ownership rights to your Velocity Innovation Challenge team members should they contribute to the advancement of the IP.

Considering these potential situations, **it is strongly recommended that you do not include any of your research work in your final submission for the Velocity Blockchain Innovation Challenge Powered by Stellar**. Your acknowledgment confirms your understanding of the potential risks that come with your participation in the Velocity Innovation Challenge.

Please acknowledge below:

I understand that I should not use any research conducted as part of my graduate studies for the Velocity Innovation Challenge.

It is also understood that I will be free to pursue and benefit from IP created during the Velocity Innovation Challenge.

Graduate Student Name: _____

_____

Signature

Thesis Advisor Name and Department: _____